new, but the majority of the content is about first steps with Elixir. In this book, you'll find Elixir code listings that walk you through theoretical examples and a practical application. We'll cover every example and project from start to finish, so you'll always know what to do next.

And if you're an experienced Elixirist reading this, maybe get a copy for your teammates.

About This Book

This book is organized into two parts. Part I is focused entirely on the fundamentals of the Elixir language. You'll learn how to read and write Elixir code during this part of the book, which will be necessary in Part II. We'll also cover slightly more advanced topics such as GenServer and the full power of pattern matching. Each section of Part I is designed to be completely standalone. The code examples are all chapter-specific, so you won't be in the dark if you decide to start out of order.

Part II is where theory meets practice. You'll write a real application that uses an API to send and receive text messages. The purpose of Part II is to introduce you to the best libraries in Elixir that are used to build robust applications. We'll cover database access, Phoenix web framework, a database-powered job system, and more. The examples in this part all build on the previous chapters, but you can start out of order with the provided code snapshots.

About the Code

Elixir is required for this book. Setup will depend on your operating system, but it's important that you're set up for success. I strongly recommend using the asdf[1] version manager to configure both Erlang and Elixir.

You'll learn about why you need different libraries in the first chapter, but it's important that you pick compatible versions of Elixir and Erlang. I recommend the versions found in Install Elixir on Your Computer, on page 10. There will be newer versions of these libraries by the time you're reading this book, so you may be able to substitute other versions. But always make sure that your Erlang version matches the OTP version of Elixir.

You'll also need to have Phoenix installed for the samples in this book. You can follow the HexDocs Installation guide[2] to get Phoenix set up. We'll cover this further at the appropriate time.

1. https://github.com/asdf-vm/asdf
2. https://hexdocs.pm/phoenix/installation.html